

# Nicholas Smith

Senior Software Engineer, UI/UX  
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## Professional Summary

Senior Software Engineer and Tech Lead with over a decade of production UI, specializing in user experience (UX) development. Led engineering at an award-winning UX design agency and the frontend team at MongoDB, re-platforming mongodb.com. Currently a Data Engineer at ATI and building AI-native products through Bright Logic Digital: semantic search, generative-AI visualizers, and Claude API features. Designs everything before building it; strongest on hard UI problems like design systems, data-heavy interfaces, and the engineering underneath them.

## Skills

### Frontend

React, TypeScript, Next.js, Vite, Tailwind CSS  
Radix UI, Framer Motion, Vue.js, D3

### Design & UX

Interaction design, design systems, Figma  
Accessibility (WCAG, ARIA)

### Languages

JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js (primary)  
Python, Swift (working proficiency)

### APIs & Backend

GraphQL, Apollo Client, REST APIs, Node.js  
Express, FastAPI, NextAuth.js

### Platform & AI

Claude API, MCP, RAG, LanceDB, Ollama  
AWS, Azure, Vercel, Docker, PostgreSQL

### Testing

Vitest, Jest, React Testing Library  
Playwright, Cypress

## Experience

### Founder & Principal Engineer

- Bright Logic Digital, LLC, Charleston, SC
- Jul 2025 – Present
- Own design and engineering end to end, from wireframes and visual design to React/TypeScript implementation.
  - Designed and launched powellsupholsteryllc.com for Powell's Upholstery, LLC: a 16,000+ fabric catalog with AI semantic search, a generative-AI visualizer that previews fabrics on a customer's own furniture, and online ordering.
  - Designed and developed Loopi, an AI-powered learning platform that generates personalized skill trees and uses FSRS spaced repetition for long-term retention. Next.js, React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, LanceDB, Claude API.

### Data Engineer

- ATI (Advanced Technology International), Charleston, SC
- Feb 2026 – Present
- Lead the data migration from a legacy contract management system to Azure, building ETL pipelines (Azure Data Factory, Databricks, Python) with LLM-based transformations to map, cleanse, and validate data.
  - Own data storage and management for Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) across Azure Storage and Databricks, enforcing access controls and data-handling requirements.
  - Build and maintain full-stack features for the consortia management application used by over 30 government contracting organizations, translating dense contract workflows into intuitive, user-friendly experiences.

### Senior Software Engineer (Frontend Tech Lead)

- MongoDB, Remote
- Dec 2022 – Jul 2025
- Led a team of engineers across 3 continents to migrate mongodb.com from an in-house CMS to Contentstack.
- Built and maintained a shared React component library published as an internal npm package, adopted by multiple MongoDB web projects, reducing duplicate UI code across teams.
  - Led a Tailwind integration that cut CSS bundle sizes by roughly 40% and shortened design-to-production time.
  - Built accessibility (semantic markup, keyboard navigation, ARIA) into the shared component library.
  - Led migration of 250+ pages onto a localization pipeline (Smartling, Contentstack localization, Next.js i18n routing) that cut publishing delays and delivered translated content 4x faster in 11 languages.
  - Enabled 5x faster page publishing (150 vs. 30 pages per batch) with a Next.js framework on Contentstack Automate.

## Senior Software Engineer, UI

Cisco Systems, Remote

Oct 2019 – Dec 2022

Developed interfaces for Cisco SecureX that transformed and aggregated unstructured data into actionable threat intelligence, reducing incident response time and increasing visibility into security posture.

- Built a threat correlation dashboard aggregating data from dozens of sources (including: Duo, Meraki, Orbital, Secure Endpoint, Umbrella) to determine CVE exposure.
- Created modular threat visualization widgets (React, D3, Recharts) that allowed non-security analysts to interpret threat data and respond to incidents.
- Developed and demoed a Threat Context POC to leadership, which greenlit it as a standalone product.

## Lead Technologist (Head of Engineering)

Handsome, Austin, TX

Jun 2018 – Jun 2019

Award-winning UX design agency whose clients included Meta, Google, Nickelodeon, FedEx, and TaxAct.

- First software engineer hired at the agency; built and led its engineering department under the CTO, working closely with industry-leading UX designers to turn research and designs into shipped web and mobile apps.
- Worked on site with client ScoreSense (consumer credit fintech) to design and build an improved onboarding flow that led to a marked increase in customer conversions.
- Led delivery for clients from startups to Fortune 50 with globally distributed teams (React, Vue.js, Webflow, AWS), providing technical direction through planning and design.

## Software Engineer III

Sovos, Boulder, CO

Mar 2016 – Feb 2017

- Led ShipCompliant's migration from ASP.NET Web Forms to React, and trained the team on best practices.
- Turned design mockups into pixel-perfect, high-fidelity UI shipped in the ShipCompliant suite.

## Founder & Principal Engineer

Dreamline Studios, LLC, Austin, TX

Jan 2016 – Jan 2019

- Designed and shipped a real-time inventory platform (Meteor, React, React Native, MongoDB, GraphQL) that cut inventory counts from 8 hours to under 3.

**Web Developer** · Fahrenheit Marketing, Austin, TX

2015

**Junior Web Developer** · White Lion, Austin, TX

2014

**Designer & Web Developer** · El Paso Spine Center, El Paso, TX

2011 – 2012

## Projects & Links

**nicksmith.software:** Personal portfolio site recreating the Mac OS X Tiger desktop in the browser (working window system, Finder, Terminal) and iOS 15 on mobile. React 18, TypeScript, Vite, Framer Motion, Zustand.

<https://nicksmith.software>

**Menubarn:** Suite of over 10 native macOS menu bar apps built on StatusItemKit, a shared Swift framework, each with a character icon drawn in code that animates with live state (a chameleon for VPN status, an owl for Claude usage).

<https://widgets.nicksmith.software>

**Centrifuge:** Browser extension for AI-powered audio stem separation using Meta's Demucs model, with real-time progress. JavaScript, Python.

<https://github.com/nicholaspsmith/Centrifuge>

**LinkedIn:** [linkedin.com/in/nps90](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nps90) | **GitHub:** [github.com/nicholaspsmith](https://github.com/nicholaspsmith) | **Studio:** [brightlogicdigital.com](https://brightlogicdigital.com)

## Education & Interests

BSBA, Management Information Systems, University of Arizona (2013)

Full Stack Developer Certification, Hack Reactor (2013)

Languages: Spanish (Conversational), Mandarin (HSK 2)

Interests: Guitar, Music Production, Language Learning (human and computer), AI, Home Automation